

5.d) Survey Research method in Anthropology

Survey research refers to the method of data collection in which quantifiable and qualitative data is collected directly by researcher.

Survey Research method's Features:-

- ① Pre-made list of questions
- ② Answers are directly filled by researcher
- ③ Questions can be quantifiable (eg) Age of informant vs qualitative (eg) Has she/he ever experienced domestic violence.
- ④ No extra questions are asked
- (Eg.) → Census 2011 ⇒ Quantifiable data mostly
→ NFHS-5 ⇒ Also qualitative data like "It used mobile" etc.

Significance

- ① Helpful in policy making and action anthropology
- ② Comparative analysis performed.
- ③ More population covered $\Rightarrow$ as without ^{knowing} the language, the interview is recorded by researcher through translation
- ④ Helpful in Longitudinal studies
(eg.) Recent 'India Ageing Report' on same method.

Issues

- ① Challenge of ~~use~~ quantifying social variable.
- ② Privacy and confidentiality of data collection.

Survey research method provides new avenues and with rise of digital AI Technology, ~~and it~~ it can be further simplified.

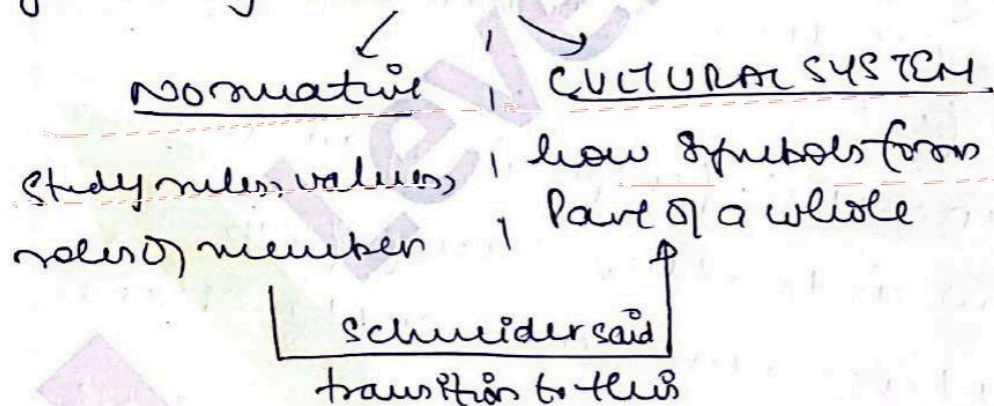
Difference from idea of Turner:-

David said even unobservable
symbols should be studied.

[Eg] Belief system and spirits don't
have physical presence but relation of
symbols to others can be done.

STUDY OF KINSHIP :-

He said "Kinship is a system
of symbols and meaning". [2] levels
of study in culture



⊛ He associated this to other symbols
like political, food, clothing etc.

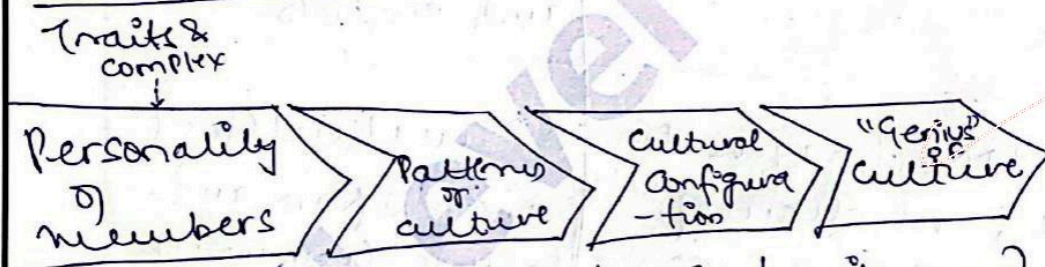
Criticism Talan Assad says such
studies are tough to replicate. They
remain descriptive. Post modernists
say TOTAL EMIC can never be got.

i.d) Pattern of Culture and Special Genius

Melville Benedict in "Patterns of Culture" along with E. Sapir expanded on this idea; as part of Culture Personality School Patterns of Culture;

Melville Benedict said patterns of culture are the smallest, integrative, repetitive units of cultural behaviour.

Configuration and Psychological approach



She stated that basic traits and complexes integrate into cultural patterns & form configuration of a culture that leads to special genius. She states

[2] such special genius

